

THIRD DIVISION

SAMUEL HARSHBARGER AND HIS DESCENDANTS.

Samuel was born Sept. 19, 1759. Like his brothers, we know nothing of his youth. He married Elizabeth Gish, 1785. Like the Ammens, into whose family his brother married, the Gishes have freely intermarried into the second and third divisions of our family. I have shown that two of Christian's daughters married Gishes. Also like the Ammens, they were an intellectual people, some being authors and a number ministers of the Gospel.

Samuel and his wife both lived in Lancaster County, Pa., but afterward came to Franklin County, where they spent the first six years of their married life. About this time the rich lands in the Shenandoah Valley were being settled. His brother Christian had gone down there to live some years before and he follows him in the autumn of 1792. His family consisted of himself, his wife, his mother, and his two children. A large company of relatives and friends migrated with him, however.

He settled a few miles north of Roanoke City, between Tinker and Carvins Creeks, a short distance above where they unite. Here he purchased a large tract of land lying principally between the two creeks. For temporary use he built a log cabin which he occupied about four years, having in the meantime constructed a two-story stone house near by on the banks of Carvin's Creek. It was so well constructed that it has endured unchanged to the present. It is about 16x20, having one room below and two above. Soon after he built a stone grist mill, just below the house and to the south. It was partly destroyed in 1877 by a flood, but what remains shows that it was a good-sized, substantial building. It was operated nearly eighty years.

His increasing family soon demanded more room. He built a frame attached to the stone house which contained three rooms. Here were housed ten persons, himself and wife, his six children, his mother, and a negro nurse. Here for more than forty years he lived a quiet life. Through these years the mill went clattering on and the broad acres yield their annual income. In time the aged mother is carried out and laid beside baby Catherine, and formed the nucleus of the Harshbarger grave yard. The children go out one by one with life partners to build new homes. But new lands have lured his

children to the West and he longs to be with them. In 1837, when nearly four score years old, he joins them in the Racoon Valley in Ind., and settled five miles southwest of Ladoga, where a dozen more years are added to his life and then he was laid to rest on the banks of Cornstalk Creek, by the side of his wife who preceeded him some two years. He died 1849.

He was a heavy-set man, well built, but not tall. Though possessed of deep feelings he was not emotional. He lacked breadth of mind, owing largely to his environments. Like the German peasants of his day he was a believer in "signs." He carefully recorded the sign of the zodiac in which each of his children was born, thinking this circumstance would affect its life. He believed his chimney would smoke if not built in the right sign of the moon. He would not cover his house until the moon was right for fear the roof would leak. Timber must be cut, fences built, seed sown when the sign was right. He had a prejudice against English people and English language so much so that he objected to Germans intermarrying with the English. In this we must not judge him harshly, for the early Germans in America were slow and very lothe to give up their language, manners and customs, and affiliate with the English. They carried this to a degree that grave fears were entertained and expressed by English statemen 150 years ago. They feared the Germans would not unify with the American people. Separate schools had to be maintained, interpreters had to be employed in the courts, documents had to be written in two languages or no business done with these immigrants. Religious services were in German only where these German colonies were strong, they were so exclusive that the English were separated from them as if an ocean intervened, and any encroachment on German life was resented. So tenacious were these Germans for their ways that when their families were scattered among the English in the West they still adhered to their language in their homes. Many of the children of our family after 1840 could not speak the English until they attended school where they had to learn it.

Samuel was a zealous Dunkard, and held a deep prejudice against all other forms of religion and would show displeasure when his relatives would attend other churches. He was a plain matter of fact man and took life earnestly. He was straightforward in all he did and said and did not hesitate to tell a man that he was a liar if he thought so, yet did it with such childlike innocence that it was impossible to get offended. Although intensely solemn in life he was not morose, but cheerful and companionable. He was not only deeply religious in nature, but carried it into his life. Before each meal he read

a passage of Scripture and prayed and after eating he returned thanks for the food. He was constant in attendance at divine service. His faith was implicit and his life devout. Like the men of his race at that age he was a slow, plodding, patient, persistent man who needed nothing but time to make a success of life.

We have a German Bible which was printed in 1755. It contains 1,400 pages. It is 16 inches long, 10½ wide and 5 thick and weighs 12 lbs. The lids are nearly half an inch thick and as solid as wood, and each of their four corners are protected by heavy brass ornamental triangular tips three inches long. It is supposed the book has been in the family over 125 years. It is now owned by Samuel Harshbarger's grandson, Samuel, son of Samuel. In this book is the birth record of Samuel and his eight children, written in German, of which I will give an exact copy in English.

Samuel Hirschberger, son of Jacob and Maria Eva Hirschberger, was born the 19th of September, 1759; entered the state of matrimony with Elizabeth Hirschberger, whose maiden name was Gischin, on the 2nd of July, 1786.

Maria was born to the world the 5th of June, 1787; died the 13th of September, 1789.

Elizabeth was born the 3rd of February, 1790, between 11 and 12 o'clock of the evening, in the sign of the Scales and the monthly sign of the Crab.

Jacob was born the 24th of June, 1792, in the afternoon between 4 and 5 o'clock, in the sign of the Virgin and in the monthly sign of the Crab.

Catherina was born the 31st of July, 1794, between 12 and 1 o'clock, noon, in the sign of the Scales and the monthly sign of the Lion.

Maria was born the 26th of December, 1796, in the morning between 2 and 3 o'clock in the sign of the Fish and the monthly sign of the Goat.

Susana was born the 28th of May, 1799, in the morning between 5 and 6 o'clock. His sign is the Ram and with monthly sign of the Twins.

Samuel was born the 11th of April, 1802, in the morning between 1 and 2 o'clock. His sign is the Lion and his monthly sign is the Goat.

Catarina was born the 18th of August 1804, in the morning between 7 and 8 o'clock. His sign is the Goat and his monthly sign is the Lion.

These records show two Marys and Catherines. The first Mary and Catherine died in infancy, leaving but six children who raised families. The first three children were

10. **Charles Himes**, b. '71, m. Rene Davidson and has Sherman, Dorris, Mildred, Samuel and Vonnie. Charles is proprietor of machine shops in Indianapolis.
11. **Charity Himes**, b. '73, m. Samuel Brubaker, a draughtsman of Indianapolis. They have Minnie, Kennith, Lethe and Joseph.
12. **Minnie Himes**, b. '75, m. John Mummert of Galveston, Ind. She has Ralph and Mary.

The Mary Nofsinger Family

Mary Harshbarger was born 1796. She m. Joseph Nofsinger, 1812, after which she lived in Va. twenty-five years, where ten of her children were born. They came to Ind 1833 and settled on the first farm south of Roachdale, where she d. 1850. She had twelve children.

1. **SALOME NOFSINGER**, b. 1813, m. Joel Britts in Va., '31. They moved to Ind. '36, and lived in Ladoga until '48. She d. in Brownsdale, Minn., '78. She also had twelve children.

1. **Edward Britts**, b. '32. He left Ladoga when 18 and engaged in the milling business at various places in the northwest, and became quite prosperous. He finally located at Verndale, Minn., and d. '08. He m. Rhoda Corbin of Ithica, N. Y., in '56, and had seven children.

Charles, b. '57. He is a banker in Duluth, Minn. He m. Bell Evans of Boston, and has two children.

Mary, b. '59, m. E. H. James of Osage, Iowa, '79, and has Maud, Clara, Evaline and Earl.

William, b. '61, m. Lizzie Smith of Portland, Oregon, in '86, and lives in Duluth.

Clara, b. '63, m. E. Swife of Duluth, in '84. She has Gail and Cora.

Alice, b. '72. She is at home.

Bruce, b. '74, m. '98, and is a banker in Virginia City, Nev.

Fred, b. '79. He is banking in Duluth

2. **Mary C. Britts**, b. '33, in Va.
3. **Caroline E. Britts**, b. '34, in Va., m. C. E. Cassidy, '72. She resides at Seattle Wash.
4. **Joseph A. Britts**, b. '36, in Va., and came to Ind. that year, moved from Ladoga to Primrose, Wis., '48. He m. Margaret Howie of Scotland, '59. He now lives at Superior, Mont. He has seven children.